

00 references and data notes

HS 090111: Coffee, not roasted or decaffeinated



South Africa imported US\$98.398 million and 22.694 million kg.

Top origins shown in the deck:

- Brazil: US\$48.982 million and 13.064 million kg.
- Ethiopia: US\$8.298 million and 1.387 million kg.
- Tanzania: US\$5.601 million and 1.157 million kg.
- Uganda: US\$4.930 million and 1.231 million kg.
- Guatemala: US\$4.749 million and 808,713 kg.

URL:

<https://wits.worldbank.org/trade/comtrade/en/country/ZAF/year/2024/tradeflow/Imports/partner/ALL/product/090111>

HS 090121: Roasted coffee, not decaffeinated



South Africa imported US\$20.543 million and 1.417 million kg.

URL:

<https://wits.worldbank.org/trade/comtrade/en/country/ZAF/year/2024/tradeflow/Imports/partner/ALL/product/090121>

HS 090112: Decaffeinated coffee, not roasted



South Africa imported US\$2.146 million and 396,986 kg.

URL:

<https://wits.worldbank.org/trade/comtrade/en/country/ZAF/year/2024/tradeflow/Imports/partner/ALL/product/090112>

HS 090122: Roasted, decaffeinated coffee



South Africa imported US\$998,460 and 43,337 kg.

URL:

<https://wits.worldbank.org/trade/comtrade/en/country/ZAF/year/2024/tradeflow/Imports/partner/ALL/product/090122>



Calculated Presentation Figures

- Total four-category coffee import volume:
 $22,694,000 + 1,416,820 + 396,986 + 43,337 = 24,551,143$ kg.
- Non-decaffeinated green coffee share:
 $22,694,000 / 24,551,143 =$ approximately 92%.
- Uganda implied green coffee import unit value:
 $\text{US\$}4.93026\text{m} / 1.23082\text{m kg} =$ approximately US\$4.01/kg.
- Ethiopia implied green coffee import unit value:
 $\text{US\$}8.29833\text{m} / 1.38719\text{m kg} =$ approximately US\$5.98/kg.



Additional Sources

- Reuters, Uganda coffee export context:
<https://www.reuters.com/markets/commodities/ugandas-february-coffee-exports-jump-28-yy-high-prices-2025-03-26/>
- SARS Customs and Excise Tariff Schedule, Chapter 9:
<https://www.sars.gov.za/wp-content/uploads/Legal/SCEA1964/Legal-LPrim-CE-Sch1P1Chpt1-to-99-Schedule-No-1-Part-1-Chapters-1-to-99.pdf>
- SARS Duties and Taxes for Importers:
<https://www.sars.gov.za/customs-and-excise/duties-and-taxes/duties-and-taxes-for-importers/>
- South African coffee, chicory and related product regulations:
https://www.gov.za/sites/default/files/gcis_document/202010/43856rg11190gon1154.pdf



01 market research summary



South Africa is structurally dependent on imported coffee, with local production remaining small relative to national consumption.



The import market is weighted heavily toward green coffee rather than finished roasted products.



In 2024, South Africa imported approximately 22.7 million kg of non-decaffeinated green coffee valued at about US\$98.4 million.



The strongest opportunity is therefore not to launch a retail coffee brand first, but to import green beans and supply local roasters, cafés, hospitality suppliers and coffee brands.

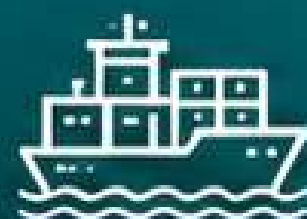


Uganda and Ethiopia are both already present in South African green coffee imports.



Research Conclusion

A coffee import and distribution model is viable if SupplySync360 validates demand first, starts with green coffee, and builds a phased East African sourcing portfolio.



2024 IMPORTS

22.7
MILLION KG

OF NON-DECAFFEINATED
GREEN COFFEE

VALUED AT ABOUT

US\$98.4
MILLION



02 south africa import dependency

South Africa Is An Import-Led Coffee Market



South African coffee demand is materially larger than domestic coffee production capacity.



Local coffee farming exists, mainly in suitable subtropical regions, but it remains niche compared to national consumption and commercial roasting demand.



This creates a recurring need for imported coffee supply.



Imported coffee supports:



Commercial roasters



Specialty roasters



Café chains



Hospitality groups



Office coffee providers



Retail coffee brands



Private-label products

Market Implication



SupplySync360 does not need to create demand for coffee.



The opportunity is to participate in an existing import-dependent market and improve how East African coffee reaches South African buyers.



03 import market by coffee type

Coffee Import Market By Type

South Africa's 2024 coffee imports show a clear preference for green coffee.

Import volumes:

Non-decaf
green coffee:



22.7
million kg



Roasted
non-decaf coffee:



1.4
million kg



Decaf
green coffee:



397,000
kg



Roasted
decaf coffee:



43,000
kg



The four-category import basket totalled approximately 24.6 million kg.

Non-decaffeinated green coffee alone represented about 92% of this volume.



GREEN BEANS
IMPORTED



ROASTING



BLENDING &
PACKAGING



BRAND
DEVELOPMENT
LOCALLY



Strategic Implication

The market prefers to import green beans and perform roasting, blending, packaging and brand development locally.

Green coffee is the logical entry product.



04 green coffee origins

Green Coffee Origins Supplying South Africa

In 2024, South Africa imported 22.7 million kg of non-decaffeinated green coffee.

Top green coffee origins by volume and value included:

	Brazil:		13.1 million kg US\$49.0m
	Ethiopia:		1.39 million kg US\$8.3m
	Uganda:		1.23 million kg US\$4.9m
	Tanzania:		1.16 million kg US\$5.6m
	Guatemala:		809,000 kg US\$4.7m

Market Insight

Uganda and Ethiopia are not speculative origins.

Both already participate in South African green coffee imports, which reduces market-entry risk for an East African sourcing strategy.



05 uganda market position

Uganda: Existing Market Acceptance



Uganda supplied approximately 1.23 million kg of non-decaffeinated green coffee to South Africa in 2024.



This placed Uganda among South Africa's leading green coffee origin countries.



Uganda's 2024 green coffee import value into South Africa was approximately US\$4.93 million.



Uganda's implied South African import unit value was approximately US\$4.01 per kg based on WITS value and volume data.

Why Uganda Matters



Uganda offers large Robusta production, growing Arabica supply, competitive pricing and commercial coffee scalability.

This makes Uganda well suited to commercial roasters, hospitality suppliers, corporate coffee programmes and espresso blend producers.

2024 EXPORT TO SOUTH AFRICA



1.23
million kg



US\$4.93
million

IMPLIED UNIT VALUE

US\$4.01
per kg



06 ethiopia market position

Ethiopia: Premium Origin With Existing Demand



Ethiopia supplied approximately 1.39 million kg of non-decaffeinated green coffee to South Africa in 2024.



The import value was approximately US\$8.30 million.



Ethiopia's implied South African import unit value was approximately US\$5.98 per kg, materially higher than Uganda's US\$4.01 per kg.



This pricing reflects Ethiopia's stronger premium and specialty positioning.



Strategic Role

Ethiopia is best suited to specialty roasters, premium cafés, direct-trade programmes, limited releases and high-margin origin-led coffee products.

Ethiopia should complement Uganda rather than replace it.

2024 EXPORT TO SOUTH AFRICA



1.39
million kg



US\$8.30
million

IMPLIED UNIT VALUE

US\$5.98
per kg



07 why green coffee is best entry

Why Green Coffee Is The Best Entry Option

Green coffee is the dominant import category.

It is already the main product format used by South African roasters and coffee businesses.

Green coffee offers:

-  Largest addressable import volume
-  Lower brand-development burden
-  Local roasting flexibility
-  Multiple buyer segments
-  Lower retail-compliance complexity
-  No need to build a consumer brand first

Roasted coffee, capsules and ready-to-drink products may offer higher margins later, but they require stronger branding, packaging, retail access and channel investment.



Strategic Conclusion

Start with green coffee to validate demand, then move into value-added formats once buyer relationships are proven.

GREEN COFFEE



BEST ENTRY OPTION



Dominant import category



Main product format used by South African roasters and coffee businesses



Lowest-risk, highest volume opportunity

ROASTED COFFEE



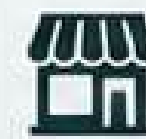
NOT THE BEST FIRST ENTRY



Lower import volume



Higher brand-development burden



Requires stronger branding, packaging and retail access

CAPSULES



NOT THE BEST FIRST ENTRY



Lower import volume



Higher retail-compliance complexity



Requires stronger branding, packaging and retail access

READY-TO-DRINK



NOT THE BEST FIRST ENTRY



Lower import volume



Higher retail-compliance complexity



Requires stronger branding, packaging and retail access

LOWER RISK • HIGHER VOLUME • EASIER ENTRY

HIGHER RISK • LOWER VOLUME • HARDER ENTRY



08 demand segments

Where Demand Exists In South Africa

Coffee demand is spread across multiple commercial channels.

Priority buyer segments:

-  **Commercial roasters:**
volume, consistency, blend economics
-  **Specialty roasters:**
origin, traceability, quality
-  **Café chains:**
repeatability and branded experience
-  **Hospitality:**
service reliability and guest experience
-  **Office coffee:**
recurring supply and cost efficiency
-  **Private label:**
differentiated products and retailer margin



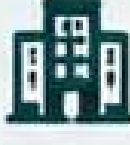
Market Insight

The opportunity is not dependent on one buyer group.

SupplySync360 can build a phased portfolio serving both commercial-volume and premium-specialty demand.



09 coffee type market fit

COFFEE TYPE		BEST FIT	SOUTH AFRICAN DEMAND AREAS				
	 Ugandan Robusta	✓ Best fit: commercial blends, espresso body, foodservice coffee, office coffee.	 Commercial Roasters	 Café Chains	 Hospitality	 Office Coffee	 Private Label
	 Ugandan Washed Robusta	✓ Best fit: premium espresso blends and emerging specialty Robusta.	 Specialty Roasters	 Café Chains	 Hospitality	 Office Coffee	 Private Label
	 Ugandan Arabica	✓ Best fit: independent roasters, African-origin blends and premium hospitality.	 Specialty Roasters	 Café Chains	 Hospitality	 Office Coffee	 Private Label
	 Ethiopian Arabica	✓ Best fit: specialty roasters, premium cafés, single-origin releases and e-commerce.	 Specialty Roasters	 Café Chains	 Hospitality	 E-commerce	 Private Label



Uganda provides scale and commercial flexibility.



Ethiopia provides premium positioning and specialty upside.



Together they create a stronger East African portfolio than either country alone.



10 importer business model

Importer-Distributor Business Model

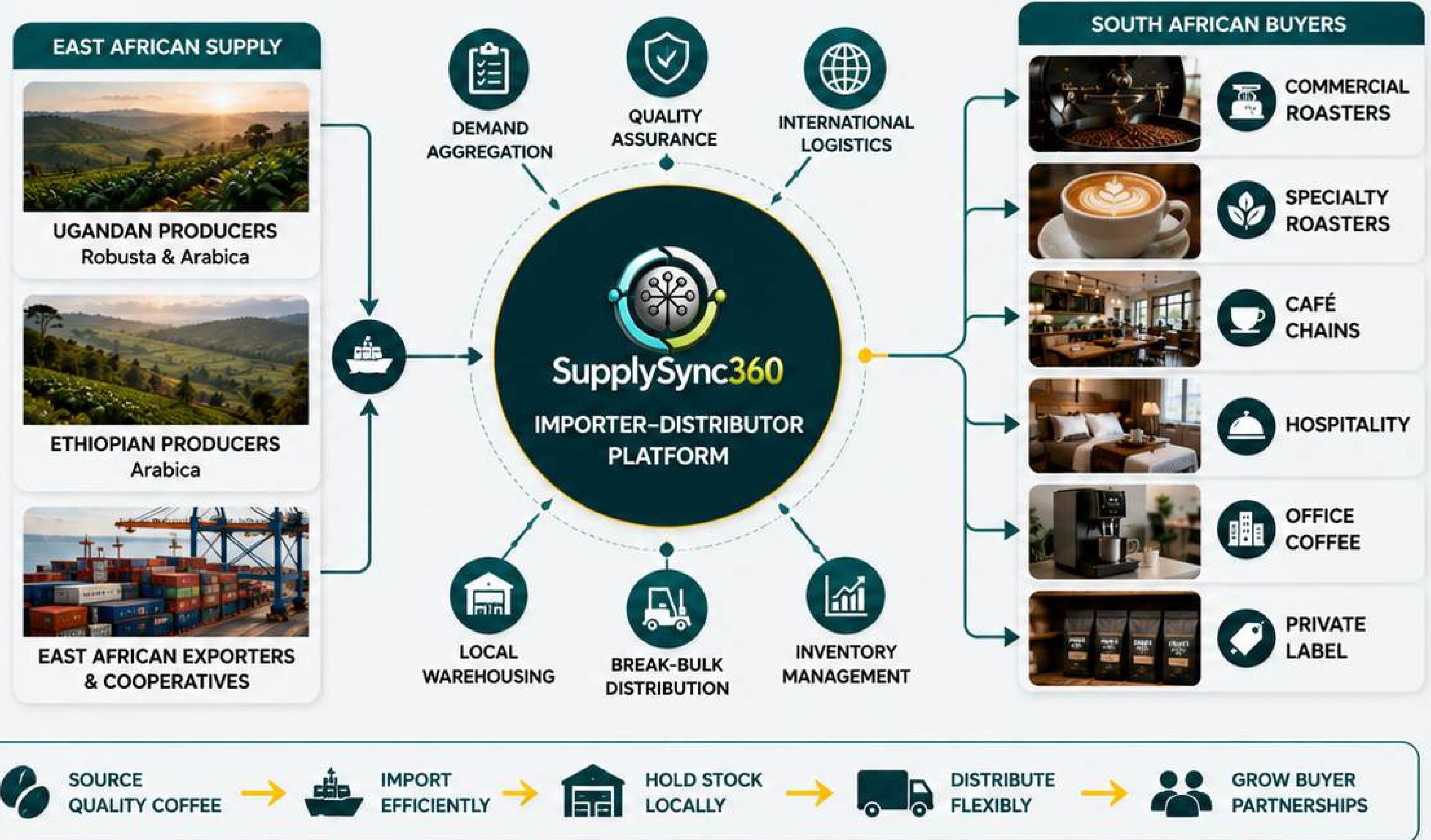
The viable business is not just buying coffee. It is coordinating supply, demand, quality, logistics and local availability.

Potential revenue layers:

-  Green coffee margin
-  Break-bulk distribution
-  Warehousing and fulfilment
-  Private-label partnerships
-  Premium specialty lots
-  Future technology services

Business Logic

-  Many smaller roasters and coffee businesses cannot efficiently import directly from East Africa.
-  SupplySync360 can aggregate demand, import in controlled volumes, hold local stock and supply buyers in flexible quantities.
-  This creates value through access, reliability and coordination.



11 supplysync360 advantage

Why SupplySync360 Is Well Positioned

Traditional coffee importers compete mainly on price, relationships and availability.

SupplySync360 can compete through a stronger operating model:

-  Supplier coordination
-  Demand aggregation
-  Inventory visibility
-  Order planning
-  Traceability
-  Logistics coordination
-  Buyer pipeline management
-  Operational reporting

EAST AFRICA SUPPLIERS



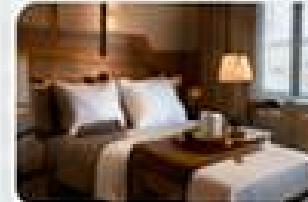
EXPORT & LOGISTICS



LOCAL WAREHOUSE & DISTRIBUTION



SOUTH AFRICAN BUYERS

-   **COMMERCIAL ROASTERS**
-   **SPECIALTY ROASTERS**
-   **CAFÉ CHAINS**
-   **HOSPITALITY**
-   **OFFICE COFFEE**
-   **PRIVATE LABEL**



Strategic Advantage

The opportunity has supply-chain complexity.



SupplySync360 already operates in the world of suppliers, inventory, demand signals and fulfilment coordination.

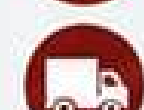
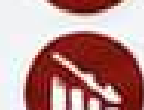


Coffee can become the first practical use case for a broader East Africa to South Africa trade corridor.

12 risk and validation

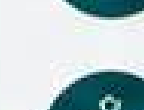
Key Risks And Validation Controls

⚠ Main risks:

-  Supplier reliability
-  Quality inconsistency
-  Logistics delays
-  Working-capital pressure
-  FX movement
-  Slow stock conversion
-  Buyer adoption risk



🛡 Validation controls:

-  Verify exporter documentation
-  Cup samples with South African roasters
-  Confirm freight and clearing costs
-  Secure pilot buyer interest
-  Start with small controlled shipments
-  Track inventory and repeat demand



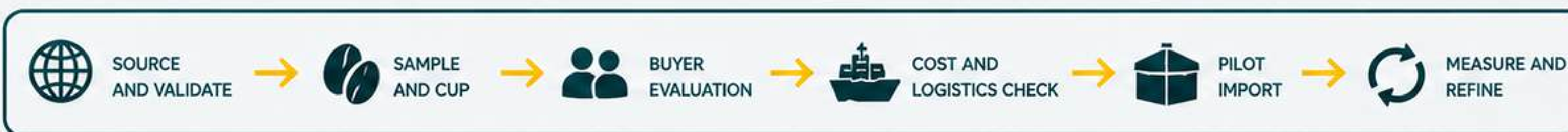
Market Entry Principle

Do not scale on assumptions.
 Scale only after supplier capability, coffee quality, logistics and customer demand are proven.



13 pilot programme

Recommended Pilot Programme



Pilot success measures:

- ✓ 3 to 5 serious buyer conversations
- ✓ Independent cupping feedback
- ✓ At least 2 pilot-ready customers
- ✓ Confirmed import pathway
- ✓ Positive margin and inventory-turnover view

Strategic Objective



The pilot should prove repeatable demand before SupplySync360 commits material capital.



14 five year opportunity

Five-Year Opportunity Pathway



From coffee imports to regional trade leadership.



Build scale, relationships and category depth.



Expand product portfolio and margin layers.



Create a durable, technology-enabled trade advantage.

Strategic Upside



Coffee is the first corridor.



The same model can later extend into tea, cocoa, vanilla, macadamia, avocado and other African agricultural products.



The long-term value is not only coffee trading. It is a regional sourcing and supply-chain platform.



15 executive recommendation

Executive Recommendation

Proceed with a structured coffee import market-entry programme.

Recommended strategy:

- 🚩 Uganda first for commercial scale and lower entry risk.
- ★ Ethiopia second for premium specialty positioning and higher-margin opportunities.
- 🌿 Green coffee first because it dominates South African import volumes and fits local roasting behaviour.
- 🛡️ SupplySync360 should start with validation, not inventory speculation.

Immediate next steps:

- ✓ Complete supplier due diligence.
- ✓ Request samples and specifications.
- ✓ Engage priority roasters and buyers.
- ✓ Confirm logistics, duties, VAT and landed costs.
- ✓ Execute a controlled pilot import.

Decision View



The research supports a viable opportunity if execution is phased, data-led and demand-validated.

